Nebulizer



Category: **Medical, Healthcare & First Aid** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Nebulizer

What it is used for

A nebulizer converts prescribed liquid medicine into a mist that can be inhaled through a mask or mouthpiece. It helps deliver medication to the airways when used according to medical instructions.

Main parts

- Identify the compressor or ultrasonic nebulizer unit, depending on the model.
- Locate the medicine cup or medication chamber.
- Identify the air tubing connecting the compressor to the medicine chamber, if fitted.
- Locate the patient mask or mouthpiece used for inhalation.
- Identify the power switch, power adapter or battery compartment.
- Locate the air filter and replacement components, where provided.
- Identify the manufacturer's instructions and prescribed medication guidance.

Before you start

1. Use the nebulizer only with medication prescribed or approved by a qualified healthcare professional.
2. Wash and dry hands before handling the device and medication.
3. Inspect the medicine chamber, tubing, mask and power connections for damage.
4. Confirm the device is clean and all components are compatible.
5. Measure the prescribed medication dose using the recommended method.
6. Place the device on a clean, dry and stable surface.
7. Ensure the user is seated comfortably in a suitable position.

How to use

1. Assemble the nebulizer according to the manufacturer's instructions.
2. Pour the prescribed medication into the medicine chamber without exceeding its marked limit.
3. Secure the chamber lid and connect the tubing and patient interface correctly.
4. Connect the power supply and position the mask or mouthpiece appropriately.
5. Switch on the device and confirm that mist is being produced.
6. Breathe normally through the mouthpiece or mask as instructed by the clinician.
7. Continue until the prescribed treatment is complete or mist production stops.
8. Switch off the device and disconnect the power supply.
9. Discard leftover medication according to medical instructions and clean reusable components.
10. Allow components to dry completely before storing them in a clean container.

⚠ Safety

- Never use unprescribed medication, oils or homemade mixtures in the nebulizer.
- Do not share masks or mouthpieces without appropriate cleaning and disinfection.
- Keep electrical connections dry and use the device according to its instructions.
- Never block the air vents or operate a damaged device.
- Stop treatment and seek medical help for severe breathing difficulty or serious adverse reactions.
- Follow the clinician's instructions for medication dose, frequency and treatment duration.

Care & storage

- Clean and disinfect reusable components according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Replace air filters and worn accessories at the recommended intervals.
- Inspect tubing and the medicine chamber regularly for cracks or blockages.
- Store the dry device in a clean, dust-free location.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using an incorrect medication or dose in the medicine chamber.
- Failing to clean reusable components between treatments.
- Using cracked tubing or a damaged medicine chamber.
- Stopping prescribed treatment early without appropriate medical guidance.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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